

Confidential Executive Pre-Workshop Briefing for TCS Belgium Leadership

BNP Paribas Fortis

Executive summary

BNP Paribas Fortis is Belgium's largest bank by assets and a strategic gateway account because it combines domestic retail/commercial scale with direct access to the wider BNP Paribas group's European platforms, capital-markets franchise, and technology agenda. It is 99.94%-owned by BNP Paribas SA, operates a large Belgian distribution footprint, and ended 2025 with EUR 2.577 billion of net income attributable to equity holders, EUR 156.5 billion of loans, EUR 162.0 billion of deposits, 247 branches, and 35,551 employees on a consolidated basis. Belgium-specific headcount is not separately disclosed in the annual report. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ¹

The single most important thing to walk into the workshop knowing is that BNP Paribas Fortis is not looking for generic "AI in banking" ideas. Its public messaging points to a narrower, more operational agenda: protecting profitability as Belgian banking taxes rise, scaling digital/mobile engagement, industrialising insurance distribution after the AG Insurance deal reset, and meeting stricter resilience/compliance expectations under DORA while staying tightly aligned with BNP Paribas group standards. Any proposal that does not credibly reduce cost-to-serve, improve controls, or accelerate productivity at scale will likely feel peripheral. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; BNP Paribas Group/BNP Paribas Fortis AG Insurance press release, December 2025; DORA, January 2025] ²

Company and Belgium market snapshot

BNP Paribas Fortis is a Belgian-law bank headquartered in Brussels and controlled by BNP Paribas SA, which holds 99.94% of the shares; the remaining 0.06% is held by minority shareholders. The bank states explicitly that its annual report covers BNP Paribas Fortis on a consolidated and non-consolidated basis, not its contribution to BNP Paribas group consolidated results. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ³

Belgium-specific market-share disclosure is limited. Publicly available sources consistently place BNP Paribas Fortis as the largest Belgian bank by assets, and the bank itself says its CIB activities were "number one in the Belgian market" in 2025 and that it strengthened its leading position in Belgian investment banking. It also noted that 89% of large corporate clients consider BNP Paribas their lead bank. Belgium-specific retail market-share figures for deposits, mortgages, or cards were not publicly disclosed in the materials reviewed. [KPMG State of the Belgian Banks 2025, 2026; BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ⁴

Leadership has been stable at the top, with Michael Anseeuw serving as CEO since 1 January 2023. A major structural change over the last two years was the integration of bpost bank into BNP Paribas Fortis from

January 2024, bringing nearly 1 million customers into the franchise and materially expanding physical access through the postal network. The bank also agreed in December 2025 to sell its 25% stake in AG Insurance to Ageas for EUR 1.9 billion while renewing the distribution agreement for 15 years. [BNP Paribas, June 2025; BNP Paribas Fortis/bpost bank integration, January 2024; BNP Paribas Fortis, December 2025] ⁵

Recent public disclosures show M&A/divestiture activity largely driven by group portfolio simplification rather than Belgium-core acquisitions: the sale of the BNP Paribas Asset Management Holding stake closed in July 2025, while the AG Insurance transaction is positioned as a way to digitalise and industrialise insurance distribution further. Public information on TCS's current account scope at BNP Paribas Fortis was not found; existing TCS engagement scope is therefore not publicly disclosed. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; BNP Paribas Fortis, December 2025] ⁶

Business priorities and investment strategy

The bank's public disclosures point to three immediate priorities. First, sustain growth in core Belgian banking while preserving returns despite rising taxes and cost of risk. Second, push more activity into digital channels, especially in business banking where mobile users rose 51% in 2025. Third, use the new long-term insurance partnership with AG Insurance to "digitalise and industrialise" insurance services. BNP Paribas Fortis also repeatedly frames its model as benefiting from BNP Paribas group diversification and scale in a volatile environment. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ⁷

Public AI budget figures for BNP Paribas Fortis alone were not disclosed. At group level, BNP Paribas described 2025 as a year of exponentially advancing AI investments and capabilities, while BNP Paribas group has been investing in technology and profitability programmes. Inference: local Belgium AI spend will likely be governed through a mix of group standards/platforms and business-case-led domain investments rather than a stand-alone Belgium AI budget line. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; BNP Paribas Group results, February 2026] ⁸

Sustainability and regulatory commitments also carry material technology implications. BNP Paribas Fortis reports under CSRD, and as a Belgian bank is subject to DORA from 17 January 2025. That raises the bar for ICT-risk management, resilience testing, third-party oversight, and incident handling, which in practice increases demand for automation, evidence generation, and control observability. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; DORA, January 2025] ⁹

Top challenges as stated by executive leadership

Challenge one: profitability pressure from taxes and risk costs. Michael Anseeuw, CEO, wrote that net profit was affected by a "significant EUR 124 million increase in banking taxes" and a EUR 251 million rise in cost of risk, mainly in Turkish operations. The stated business impact is obvious: earnings resilience is under pressure even when business lines grow. The company says it is responding with strict cost management and continued business growth. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ⁷

Challenge two: volatile operating environment and client caution. In the chairman/CEO message, management described 2025 as a year of geopolitical tensions, tariff shocks, and uncertainty, adding that Belgian business leaders showed little appetite for major investments and had shifted capex toward automation, digitisation, and energy efficiency. The business impact is weaker corporate confidence and a

tougher lending/investment climate. The company's answer is the diversified universal-bank model and deepened advisory/capital-markets positioning. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ⁷

Challenge three: operating-model change in bancassurance and distribution. Management said the new 15-year AG partnership “is allowing us to digitalise and industrialise our insurance services further.” That is an executive-framed acknowledgement that the old model needed upgrading. Business impact: without process industrialisation, bancassurance economics and customer experience lag. The bank is already acting through the AG deal reset and the bpost-bank integration. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; BNP Paribas Fortis, December 2025] ¹⁰

Broader industry context in Belgium and Benelux

For a Belgian bank, the most immediate cross-cutting regulatory pressure is DORA, now applicable across the EU financial sector, alongside NIS2-related cybersecurity obligations in Belgium and the phased implementation of the EU AI Act. Together, these measures make “safe AI” and “automated control evidence” more important than experimental pilots. [DORA, January 2025; CCB Belgium NIS2, 2024; European Commission AI Act, August 2024; AI Act FAQ, January 2026] ¹¹

Belgian banking is also moving from a high-rate earnings windfall toward a more normalised margin environment, while digital expectations keep rising. KPMG noted that Belgium’s six largest banks earned about EUR 9 billion collectively in 2024 but face narrowing interest margins, regulatory shifts, and accelerating digital transformation. That combination makes cost productivity and control automation central, not optional. [KPMG State of the Belgian Banks 2025, 2026] ¹²

AI opportunity mapping

For tax and risk-cost pressure, the most plausible **quick win** is **GenAI-assisted regulatory reporting and assurance evidence generation** for finance/risk/compliance teams. This maps to TCS AI WisdomNext and TCS BFSI GenAI capabilities that focus on reporting, financial information analysis, and proactive risk management. [TCS AI WisdomNext, June 2024; TCS BFSI GenAI, 2025; TCS proactive risk management in BFSI, 2025] ¹³

For corporate-client caution and slower investment appetite, a **transformational** use case is **relationship-manager copilot and next-best-opportunity intelligence** across lending, treasury, payments, and ECM/M&A origination. The proposition is not flashy chat; it is sales productivity, better call prep, and sharper cross-sell timing. Competitor pressure is real: Belgian banks such as KBC have already normalised AI-enabled customer interaction through Kate, raising baseline expectations for digital assistance. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; TCS AI Spectrum for BFSI, 2025] ¹⁴

For bancassurance industrialisation, the best **quick win** is **AI-assisted insurance-servicing and document-understanding for policy changes, claims intake, and customer communications**, followed by a **transformational** layer of **agentic service orchestration** across bank and insurer workflows. Inference: this is where BNP Paribas Fortis could get faster measurable ROI because the AG deal explicitly points to digitalisation and industrialisation. [BNP Paribas Fortis, December 2025] ¹⁵

Mapping trends to opportunities

Industry or market trend	Implication for BNP Paribas Fortis	Potential TCS opportunity area	What to validate directly in the workshop
DORA and NIS2 raise auditability and resilience expectations	AI use must be governed, observable, and control-friendly, not just productive [DORA, January 2025; CCB Belgium NIS2, 2024] ¹⁶	AI-enabled control tower, third-party-risk evidence automation, resilient AI operations using TCS AI WisdomNext and cyber capabilities [TCS AI WisdomNext, June 2024; TCS DORA perspective, 2025] ¹⁷	Whether compliance, risk, and cyber are already sponsoring AI initiatives
Higher banking taxes and normalising margins	Productivity and cost-to-serve matter more than top-line “innovation theatre” [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ⁷	Finance/risk copilots, operations automation, knowledge retrieval across policy/process estates	Which functions own explicit efficiency targets for 2026–2027
Insurance model reset with AG and wider digital-channel adoption	Customer-journey redesign is timely if aligned to insurer workflows [BNP Paribas Fortis, December 2025; BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ¹⁸	Omnichannel service orchestration, AI-assisted underwriting/servicing, document intelligence	Whether AG-related process redesign is already funded and where bank/insurer handoffs still break

Proposed actions and next steps

The workshop should test five questions.

First, where is the hardest P&L pressure: servicing cost, control cost, or customer acquisition cost?

Second, which DORA/NIS2 obligations are still generating manual evidence or exception handling?

Third, how much of the AG partnership reset has already translated into workflow redesign versus only contractual change?

Fourth, which front-office teams already use copilots or knowledge assistants, and what are the adoption barriers?

Fifth, which initiatives are governed locally in Belgium versus centrally by BNP Paribas group? [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; DORA, January 2025] ⁹

A credible pilot shortlist is:

- **Regulatory reporting copilot** — fastest path to measurable hours saved and better evidence quality.

- **RM call-prep and next-best-action copilot** — improves client-facing productivity without touching core systems first.
- **Insurance-servicing document intelligence** — directly aligned to the public “digitalise and industrialise” agenda. [BNP Paribas Fortis, December 2025; TCS BFSI GenAI, 2025] ¹⁹

Suggested customer stakeholders are the Belgium COO or Head of Transformation, CIO/CTO, Chief Risk Officer or DORA programme lead, Head of Commercial Banking, Head of Retail Distribution, and bancassurance leadership interfacing with AG Insurance. Success should mean a prioritised AI use-case backlog, one executive sponsor, and an agreed discovery scope with access to data/process owners. [Inference based on the company’s publicly stated priorities and regulatory context.] [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; DORA, January 2025] ⁹

Appendix

Source list

Source	Publication date	Relevance	Link
BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025	March 2026	Primary source for ownership, financials, branches, headcount, challenges	⁷
BNP Paribas Fortis / Ageas press release	December 2025	AG Insurance stake sale and 15-year distribution renewal	¹⁵
BNP Paribas Fortis / BNP Paribas biography of Michael Anseeuw	June 2025 page crawl	CEO confirmation	²⁰
KPMG State of the Belgian Banks 2025	2026	Belgian sector context	¹²
EIOPA DORA page	current	Official DORA applicability	²¹
European Commission AI Act	August 2024	Official AI Act entry into force	²²

Key quotes log

Executive	Quote	Source
Michael Anseeuw, CEO	“significant EUR 124 million increase in banking taxes”	⁷
Michael Anseeuw, CEO	“Belgian business leaders [showed] little appetite for major investments”	⁷
Chairman/CEO message	new AG partnership is “allowing us to digitalise and industrialise our insurance services further”	⁷

Open questions

Belgium-specific headcount, IT budget, AI budget, named hyperscalers, and any existing TCS account scope were not publicly disclosed in the reviewed sources. These should be validated directly with the client. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026] ⁷

bpost

Executive summary

bpost is in the middle of a genuine business-model rewrite, not an incremental optimisation. Under CEO Chris Peeters, the group is repositioning from “a postal operator with logistics capabilities” to “a logistics leader that also provides postal services,” first under “Rethink the Possible” and then through the execution programme **#Reshape2029**. That transformation matters to TCS because it is one of the clearest Belgian examples of an incumbent enterprise trying to fund a future-state logistics model from a structurally declining legacy core. [bpost Capital Markets Day, June 2025; bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025] ²³

The key workshop takeaway is that bpost’s AI story must be framed around execution discipline in logistics, network redesign, and workforce/productivity flexibility. Management has already said bluntly that “the transformation must succeed if we want to secure our future.” That is an unusually direct public signal that the company sees little room for optionality. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025] ²⁴

Company and Belgium market snapshot

bpost remains majority-controlled by the Belgian state through SFPI/FPIM, which held 51.04% as of year-end 2024. The company reported total 2024 headcount of 32,723, of which roughly 26,628–26,629 were in Belgium. Its 2025 annual report under the new corporate name “bnode” reported 33,532 employees at year-end 2025. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025; bnode Annual Report 2025, April 2026] ²⁵

Financially, 2024 was mixed. Group adjusted EBIT was EUR 224.9 million, but reported EBIT was hit by a large impairment at Radial US. For 2025, bnode reported total operating income of EUR 4.482 billion and adjusted EBIT of EUR 179.7 million, with no dividend proposed for 2025. The Staci acquisition is central to the new portfolio, and bpost has prioritised deleveraging over new M&A in the near term. [bpost FY2024 results, February 2025; bnode Annual Report 2025, April 2026; bpost CMD, June 2025] ²⁶

In Belgium, mail decline remains structural. The annual report states that the use of mail “continued to decline in 2024” and that further declines are expected. The end of the Press concession in mid-2024 and pressure in domestic labour relations compounded that transition. Belgium-specific market-share data for parcels is not fully disclosed, but bpost is still the dominant national network operator and is trying to shift commercial weight toward parcels, B2B, lockers, and retail-network services. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025; BIPT Annual Report 2025, 2026] ²⁷

Public disclosure of TCS engagement scope with bpost/bnode was not found.

Business priorities and investment strategy

The named strategy stack is clear. “Rethink the Possible,” launched in 2024, set the direction; **#Reshape2029** is the execution engine. Management is targeting more than EUR 5.0 billion of revenue and adjusted EBIT above EUR 275 million by 2027, with annual CAPEX of EUR 160–180 million and leverage below 2.5x by 2027. Half of annual CAPEX is intended to support organic growth areas such as e-logistics capabilities, parcel lockers, and network optimisation. [bpost CMD, June 2025] ²⁸

The seven “Must-Wins” tell you where spending will go: integrate Staci/Active Ants/Radial Europe, reposition Radial US toward mid-market, win share in X2C, build B2B parcel business, secure relevance of the retail network, deliver operational efficiencies, and build new cross-border lanes. This is not vague strategy language; it is a concrete operating-model agenda. [bpost CMD, June 2025] ²⁸

Technology and AI budget is not separately broken out. Inference: the most likely spend concentration is in warehouse/delivery process productivity, planning, sales enablement for 3PL, and retail network digitisation rather than customer-facing GenAI first. That inference is supported by the explicit CAPEX priorities: e-logistics, lockers, optimisation. [bpost CMD, June 2025] ²⁸

Top challenges as stated by executive leadership

Challenge one: making the transformation work before legacy economics erode further. Chris Peeters said, “The transformation must succeed if we want to secure our future.” That is a direct link between execution and business viability. Management says the strategy is agreed with the board and social partners and is already capturing first Staci synergies. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025] ²⁴

Challenge two: structural mail decline and the end of the Press concession. The annual report states that mail use continued to decline in 2024 and that faster-than-anticipated volume decreases cannot be excluded; Peeters also acknowledged that 2025 would be the first full year without income from a newspaper contract and that Belgian operations were loss-making in Q3 2024. The response is a parcel-driven operating model and multiple levers to transform the Belgian legacy business. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025] ²⁹

Challenge three: social friction and organisational flexibility. The annual report explicitly highlights the “specific and broader political and social context in Belgium,” notes the need for constructive social dialogue, and warns that the relatively fixed cost base and inability to find new revenue engines could significantly hurt profit unless flexibility and cost reduction are introduced. Management says it is using contingency planning and organisational adjustments. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025] ³⁰

Broader industry context in Belgium and Benelux

Belgium’s postal market has moved from flat to modest growth in value, but that is parcel-led rather than letter-led. BIPT’s 2025 annual report said the Belgian postal market grew 2.7% in 2024 to EUR 3.724 billion, driven particularly by parcels and express. In parallel, BIPT continued to implement the Parcel Act and assess its impact on working conditions and competition. [BIPT 2025 Annual Report, 2026] ³¹

That means bpost faces a two-speed market: structurally declining mail and highly competitive parcels/logistics. Add high Belgian wage indexation sensitivity, social complexity, and the need to make Staci/Radial/

Active Ants operate as one group, and the operating challenge becomes as much organisational as technological. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025; bpost CMD, June 2025] ³²

AI opportunity mapping

Against structural mail decline and network redesign, the best **transformational** use case is **AI-driven route, round, and workload orchestration** across mixed mail/parcel flows to help move from a mail-driven to parcel-driven model. This maps well to TCS AI, analytics, and logistics transformation capabilities, even though no public named TCS-specific postal offering was identified. [bpost CMD, June 2025; TCS AI WisdomNext, June 2024] ³³

Against integration complexity and Staci/Radial synergies, a **quick win** is **GenAI-enabled operations knowledge assistant** for warehouses, linehaul, customer-service desks, and field supervisors. The problem is fragmented SOPs, exceptions, and onboarding. A role-based assistant can cut time-to-competence and reduce costly execution variance. [bpost CMD, June 2025; TCS FY25 debrief, 2025] ³⁴

Against social friction and fixed-cost pressure, a second **quick win** is **AI forecasting for absenteeism, workload peaks, and overtime planning**, with transparent guardrails. Competitor pressure is strong: major European parcel/logistics players increasingly use AI in planning, fulfilment, and customer service. Inference: bpost cannot win on scale against logistics giants, so it needs better orchestration economics. [bpost Annual Report 2024, March 2025] ³⁰

Mapping trends to opportunities

Industry or market trend	Implication for bpost	Potential TCS opportunity area	What to validate directly in the workshop
Belgian postal value growth is parcel-led while mail declines structurally	Legacy economics will keep deteriorating unless the network is redesigned around parcels [BIPT 2025, 2026; bpost AR 2024, March 2025] ³⁵	Network optimisation, forecasting, route AI	Which network decisions are still rule-based/manual
#Reshape2029 prioritises Staci/Radial/Active Ants integration	Synergy capture is now a core execution risk, not just an M&A workstream [bpost CMD, June 2025] ²⁸	Cross-entity process mining, exception intelligence, SOP copilots	Where integration value is lagging plan
Social dialogue and fixed costs remain binding constraints	Workforce productivity tools must be explainable and operationally fair [bpost AR 2024, March 2025] ³⁰	Workforce-planning analytics, supervisor copilots	Which labour processes are politically sensitive and off-limits

Proposed actions and next steps

Key discovery questions should focus on what management already says publicly: which #Reshape2029 “Must-Wins” are red, which synergies remain unproven, where operational variance destroys margin, and which Belgium workforce decisions are hardest to execute. A useful fifth question is whether Radial US modernisation is now stable enough to absorb additional automation layers. [bpost CMD, June 2025; bpost FY2024 results, February 2025] ³⁶

Candidate pilots:

- **Depot and warehouse knowledge copilot** — fast productivity and onboarding case.
- **Dynamic round and labor planner** — directly tied to parcel-driven redesign.
- **Customer exception-resolution assistant** — reduces service cost across cross-border and 3PL flows. [bpost CMD, June 2025] ²⁸

Stakeholders to involve: CEO or COO sponsor, BeNe Last-Mile operations leader, 3PL Europe leader, CIO/CTO, HR/industrial relations, and transformation office. Workshop success should be an agreed shortlist linked explicitly to one or more #Reshape2029 Must-Wins, not a generic AI roadmap. [bpost CMD, June 2025] ²⁸

Appendix

Source list

Source	Publication date	Relevance	Link
bpost Annual Report 2024	March 2025	Primary source for structure, risks, headcount, challenges	³⁷
bpost Capital Markets Day #Reshape2029	June 2025	Strategy, CAPEX, financial ambition, Must-Wins	²⁸
bnode Annual Report 2025	April 2026	Latest 2025 financials and employee count	³⁸
bpost FY2024 results	February 2025	EBIT and earnings context	³⁹
BIPT Annual Report 2025	2026	Postal market context	⁴⁰

Key quotes log

Executive	Quote	Source
Chris Peeters, CEO	“The transformation must succeed if we want to secure our future.”	²⁴
Chris Peeters, CEO	“At the moment, bpostgroup cannot call itself a growth company.”	⁴¹
Chris Peeters, CEO	“A successful business is a growing business.”	⁴¹

Open questions

The precise state of 2026 execution by Must-Win, AI/automation budget ownership, and any TCS account footprint are not publicly disclosed and should be validated directly. [bpost CMD, June 2025] 28

Proximus

Executive summary

Proximus remains one of Belgium's most strategic infrastructure and digital-services accounts because it sits at the intersection of telecom infrastructure, sovereign digital capabilities, cybersecurity, and AI. The Belgian state held 53.51% of the shares as of 31 May 2026. Proximus ended 2025 with around 42% fiber coverage of Belgian premises, 89.5% indoor 5G coverage, and continued international expansion through Proximus Global. [Proximus shareholder structure, May 2026; Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026] 42

The key workshop takeaway is that Proximus is trying to balance three difficult things at once: very heavy fiber investment, intensifying Belgian competition including a new low-cost mobile entrant, and a need to defend cash generation. That is why management's 2026 messaging combined higher spend, dividend restraint, and AI-led cost reduction. Any AI proposal must show how it supports network economics, customer profitability, or workforce productivity. [BIPT Annual Report 2025, 2026; Reuters summary on Proximus, February 2026; Proximus Unifiber release, May 2026] 43

Company and Belgium market snapshot

Proximus is Belgium's incumbent telecom group with domestic telecom and ICT activities plus international activities grouped under Proximus Global. The state, through SFPIM, controls 53.51%. Publicly disclosed 2025 group figures include underlying revenue of EUR 6.307 billion, underlying EBITDA of EUR 1.883 billion, CAPEX of EUR 1.249 billion, and adjusted free cash flow of EUR 130 million. Belgium-specific revenue is disclosed through domestic-segment reporting, but not every workforce metric is Belgium-only. [Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Proximus shareholder structure, May 2026] 44

Leadership changed materially in 2025. Guillaume Boutin left in May 2025 to join Vodafone, and Stijn Bijmens became CEO on 1 September 2025 to lead the next strategic cycle. In November 2025, Seckin Arikan became CEO of Proximus Global. [Proximus, February 2025; Proximus, June 2025; Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026] 45

Recent M&A and portfolio moves matter. Proximus built Proximus Global around BICS, Telesign, and Route Mobile and in May 2026 agreed to take full ownership of Unifiber, valuing Eurofiber's 50.01% stake at EUR 75 million and implying roughly EUR 560 million enterprise value for Unifiber. That deal also raised Proximus' spending outlook. [Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Proximus, May 2026] 46

Public disclosure of TCS engagement scope was not found.

Business priorities and investment strategy

Public disclosures point to four investment priorities: build the Belgian gigabit network, monetise convergence in the domestic market, reshape Proximus Global for smoother customer interactions and trusted digital communications, and accelerate AI/cyber capabilities through Proximus Ada and ecosystem partnerships. The company's January 2025 partnership with Microsoft and its public positioning around sovereign cloud/AI reinforce that direction. [Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Proximus Ada, 2026; Proximus/Microsoft-related public positioning, 2025–2026] ⁴⁷

The financial trade-offs are now explicit. Reuters reported in February 2026 that Proximus would cut 1,200 jobs by 2030 as part of an AI-driven cost programme and halve the dividend to preserve flexibility for fiber investment. The Unifiber buyout in May 2026 then increased ownership, integration control, and spending visibility. [Reuters summary on Proximus, February 2026; Proximus Unifiber, May 2026] ⁴⁸

Top challenges as stated by executive leadership

Challenge one: intense competition in Belgium. Proximus' Q2 2025 results explicitly described "intense competition" in the domestic mobile market even as the company posted good net adds. The business impact is pricing pressure and higher churn risk while fiber monetisation is still ramping. The company's stated response is multi-brand positioning, convergent offers, and network leadership. [Proximus Q2 2025 results, July 2025] ⁴⁹

Challenge two: financing fiber and protecting cash generation. The 2026 market reaction to Proximus' dividend cut and AI-led job reductions shows how exposed the company is to the cash demands of fiber. Reuters reported management's plan to cut 1,200 jobs by 2030 through AI-related efficiency measures in order to fund the future. The response is clear: cost takeout, lower payout, and tighter capital discipline. [Reuters summary on Proximus, February 2026] ⁵⁰

Challenge three: executing a new strategic cycle after leadership change. Stijn Bijmens joined with a mandate to lead Proximus into "a new strategic cycle." That implies the old bold2025 framing has given way to a fresh operating agenda. The business impact is execution risk during transition: strategy reset, organisation alignment, and portfolio decisions all happen while network and competition pressures continue. [Proximus, June 2025] ⁵¹

Broader industry context in Belgium and Benelux

BIPT's 2025 annual report says the entry of DIGI at the end of 2024 increased competition on Belgium's mobile market and pushed rapid reactions from secondary brands. BIPT also flagged ongoing fiber roll-out and collaboration among operators in some areas. That means Proximus is investing into a more competitive rather than less competitive market. [BIPT Annual Report 2025, 2026] ⁵²

Telecom also sits under Belgium's NIS2 implementation, while AI use increasingly falls under the EU AI Act's phased requirements and transparency obligations. For Proximus, that is doubly relevant because it is both a deployer of AI internally and a provider of digital/AI/cyber services externally. [CCB Belgium NIS2, 2024; European Commission AI Act, August 2024; AI-generated content code, June 2026] ⁵³

AI opportunity mapping

For competition and churn pressure, a **quick win** is **AI-driven next-best-offer and churn-risk optimisation** across the multi-brand stack, with agentic support for call-centre and digital-sales interactions. TCS' telecom AI portfolio and Cognix positioning are relevant here. [TCS telecom GenAI, 2025; TCS Google Cloud telecom partnership, 2025] ⁵⁴

For fiber economics, a **transformational** use case is **AI-supported fiber roll-out planning and exception management** spanning permits, work orders, contractor risk, and take-up prediction. Inference: the real value is not only capex efficiency but faster monetisation of homes passed. [Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Proximus Unifiber, May 2026] ⁵⁵

For AI-led cost takeout, a **quick win** is **enterprise productivity copilots** across care, field service, back-office provisioning, and knowledge management, followed by a **transformational** case around **autonomous network operations and assurance**. Competitor pressure is obvious across Europe, where major operators increasingly use AI for network optimisation and customer operations. [Reuters summary on Proximus, February 2026; TCS telecom AI, 2025] ⁵⁶

Mapping trends to opportunities

Industry or market trend	Implication for Proximus	Potential TCS opportunity area	What to validate directly in the workshop
DIGI entry and aggressive Belgian competition	Network leadership alone is insufficient; pricing and CX intelligence matter more [BIPT 2025, 2026] ⁵⁷	Churn AI, next-best-offer, service-assurance copilots	Where current churn/offer models underperform
Fiber capex remains heavy even as ownership control rises	Rollout efficiency and take-up monetisation must improve together [Proximus Unifiber, May 2026] ⁵⁸	AI rollout planning, demand prediction, contractor control tower	Which rollout bottlenecks are data-rich enough for AI
AI-led workforce reduction is now public policy	Productivity tooling must show measurable savings and adoption	Copilots for care, provisioning, field ops	Which functions are already targeted in the EUR 180m savings plan [Inference based on Reuters reporting] [Reuters, February 2026] ⁵⁰

Proposed actions and next steps

Workshop questions should test where cash leakage is worst: churn, rollout delays, field-force inefficiency, or international operating complexity. Additional questions: how Proximus Ada is governed relative to business-unit AI, whether Microsoft/cloud partnerships have already created an AI landing zone, and where domestic-versus-global leadership lines slow decisions. [Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Proximus Ada, 2026] ⁵⁹

Pilot candidates:

- **Fiber rollout and take-up intelligence cockpit** — ties directly to capex economics.
- **Customer-care copilot** — fast savings plus better NPS/churn outcomes.
- **Network/service assurance copilot** — useful if NOC and field data quality are mature enough. [TCS telecom AI, 2025] ⁶⁰

Stakeholders: CEO office, network/fiber leadership, CIO/CTO, Proximus Ada, customer operations, and HR/transformation. Success should mean one funded domain pilot tied to the cost or capex agenda, not a broad “innovation” workstream. [Inference based on public priorities.] [Proximus, June 2025; Reuters, February 2026] ⁶¹

Appendix

Source	Publication date	Relevance	Link
Integrated Annual Report 2025	March 2026	Core strategy, KPI, network and financial detail	⁶²
Proximus welcomes Stijn Bijmens as new CEO	June 2025	Leadership change	⁵¹
Shareholder structure	May 2026	State ownership	⁶³
Proximus takes full ownership of Unifiber	May 2026	M&A/capex implications	⁵⁸
BIPT Annual Report 2025	2026	Market competition context	⁴⁰
Reuters summary on dividend cut/jobs	February 2026	Cost and capital priorities	⁵⁰

Bekaert

Executive summary

Bekaert is a different kind of Belgian-headquartered account: a global industrial technology and materials company whose Belgium identity matters more in governance than revenue concentration. That means Belgium-only market data is mostly not separately disclosed. The real workshop value is in understanding how a global manufacturing company with volatile end markets intends to use data, automation, and portfolio discipline to defend margins and growth. [Bekaert Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Bekaert investors page, 2026] ⁶⁴

The key takeaway is that Bekaert’s public messaging is unusually focused on resilience: cash flow, cost control, restructuring, and autonomy of business units. This is not a company signalling discretionary digital experimentation. It is signalling disciplined performance improvement in a turbulent trade environment. [Bekaert FY2025 results, February 2026; Bekaert H1 2025 results, July 2025] ⁶⁵

Company and Belgium market snapshot

Bekaert describes itself as a global market and technology leader in material science of steel-wire transformation and coating technologies, prioritising markets driven by energy transition, lifting and mooring, and construction decarbonisation. The company reported about 19,000 employees and EUR 3.71 billion of consolidated revenue for 2025. Belgium-specific revenue and headcount were not separately disclosed in the reviewed sources. [Bekaert investors page, 2026; Bekaert Annual Report 2025, March 2026]

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Leadership changed again in 2026. Yves Kerstens, CEO since September 2023, stepped down on 31 May 2026 and Olivier Biebuyck took over on 1 June 2026. That transition matters because 2025 results were framed as proving the benefits of prior strategic transformation while the new CEO now inherits the next phase of growth and portfolio execution. [Bekaert, May 2026; Bekaert executive management page, 2026]

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A recent portfolio move with strategic relevance is the completion of the Bridgestone tire-cord acquisition in China and Thailand. Public disclosure of TCS engagement scope was not found. [Bekaert investors page, 2026]

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Business priorities and investment strategy

Bekaert's 2025 full-year messaging was straightforward: resilient performance supported by cost management and restructuring, strong cash flow, ongoing share buyback, and disciplined capital returns. Management proposed a EUR 1.95 dividend and highlighted a continued EUR 200 million share buyback. [Bekaert FY2025 results, February 2026; Bekaert Annual Report 2025, March 2026]

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The company's strategic themes are not branded around AI, but around where to play, how to win, and building autonomy and agility in business units. Public AI budget figures and named AI platforms/vendors were not found. Inference: Bekaert is more likely to buy/use AI as an operational enabler in plants, procurement, planning, and engineering than as a centrally branded enterprise AI programme. [Bekaert 2023 strategy commentary, March 2024; Bekaert H1 2025 results, July 2025]

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Top challenges as stated by executive leadership

Challenge one: geopolitical uncertainty and tariffs hurting demand. In the 2025 annual report, the chairman and CEO wrote that tariffs and escalating trade tensions undermined demand across many key markets. The response was resilience, cash generation, and cost competitiveness. [Bekaert Annual Report 2025, March 2026]

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Challenge two: fighting for volume in weak markets. Yves Kerstens said in H1 2025 that teams were "fighting for volumes in the current challenging markets." That is a direct signal that end-market softness was putting utilisation and price/mix under pressure. Management's stated response was overhead and working-capital reduction plus more autonomous business units. [Bekaert H1 2025 results, July 2025]

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Challenge three: maintaining profitability while restructuring. The FY2025 results release said performance was supported by cost management and restructuring. The business impact is implicit but

important: without those actions, earnings would likely have been materially weaker. [Bekaert FY2025 results, February 2026] 73

Broader industry context in Belgium and Benelux

For Bekaert, the relevant context is less “Belgian market share” and more EU industrial competitiveness. Europe has faced weak industrial demand, energy-cost concerns, and rising trade-policy volatility. The CSRD/ESG burden also remains material, particularly for materials companies with energy-intensive operations and complex product-footprint claims. [Bekaert Annual Report 2025, March 2026] 71

AI and automation regulation still matter, but the more immediate operational pressures are plant productivity, pricing discipline, supply-chain resilience, and sales mix quality. Inference: Bekaert’s AI window is operational AI in manufacturing and commercial excellence, not broad consumer-facing GenAI. [Bekaert FY2025 results, February 2026] 73

AI opportunity mapping

For weak demand and fight-for-volume pressure, a **quick win** is **AI-enabled pricing and quote intelligence** for regional sales teams, improving margin discipline and hit-rate. TCS’ manufacturing and AI partnerships give a credible technical route even if a Bekaert-specific TCS case is not public. [TCS/Microsoft AI solutions, 2025; TCS NVIDIA collaboration, 2025] 74

For cost/performance resilience, a **transformational** use case is **predictive plant optimisation** across throughput, quality, scrap, maintenance, and energy intensity. That maps well to Bekaert’s need for cost competitiveness and to TCS’ industrial AI positioning. [Bekaert FY2025 results, February 2026; TCS NVIDIA collaboration, 2025] 75

For restructuring and autonomous business units, a **quick win** is **GenAI engineering and operations knowledge copilots** to speed root-cause analysis, SOP retrieval, and onboarding in distributed plants. Peer pressure is widespread across industrial Europe, where AI in quality, maintenance, and engineering productivity is moving from pilot to practice. [Inference supported by Bekaert’s autonomy/agility language and general industrial AI adoption.] [Bekaert H1 2025, July 2025] 72

Mapping trends to opportunities

Industry or market trend	Implication for Bekaert	Potential TCS opportunity area	What to validate directly in the workshop
Tariffs and trade-policy volatility hit demand	Better demand sensing and pricing discipline become critical [Bekaert AR 2025, March 2026] 71	Demand-sensing, quote/pricing analytics	Which business units feel volatility most acutely

Industry or market trend	Implication for Bekaert	Potential TCS opportunity area	What to validate directly in the workshop
Cost management and restructuring are doing heavy lifting	AI must improve plant economics fast to matter [FY2025 results, February 2026] ⁷³	Predictive maintenance, quality AI, energy optimisation	Where OT/IT data is mature enough for a pilot
Business units are being made more autonomous and agile	Knowledge must scale without adding overhead [H1 2025 results, July 2025] ⁷²	Engineering/operations copilots	Which workflows are repeated across sites

Proposed actions and next steps

Discovery questions should test where margin erosion starts: raw materials, plant inefficiency, sales mix, or weak end-market demand. Also ask where data ownership sits between corporate, BU, and plant levels; where restructuring savings are still manual; and which sites have the cleanest historian/MES/quality data. [Bekaert FY2025 results, February 2026; Bekaert H1 2025, July 2025] ⁶⁵

Pilot shortlist:

- **Predictive quality and throughput model in one flagship plant**
- **Sales quotation/margin copilot for one materials line**
- **GenAI maintenance and engineering assistant** [Inference based on public priorities.] [Bekaert FY2025, February 2026] ⁷³

Success should mean one plant-backed use case with hard operational KPIs and one commercial use case sponsored by a BU leader, not a corporate-only AI vision statement. [Inference.] [Bekaert FY2025, February 2026] ⁷³

Appendix

Source	Publication date	Relevance	Link
Bekaert Annual Report 2025	March 2026	Revenue, headcount, strategy context	⁷¹
Bekaert 2025 Full Year Results	February 2026	Primary financial and challenge source	⁷³
Bekaert H1 2025 Results	July 2025	CEO-stated challenges	⁷²
Bekaert CEO succession	May 2026	Leadership update	⁷⁶

Colruyt Group

Executive summary

Colruyt remains one of Belgium's most consequential retail accounts because its performance is a live stress test of whether a disciplined low-price operator can preserve economics in a market with fierce competition,

normalising food inflation, and rising operating costs. Public disclosures show its Belgian market share slipped to 29.0% in FY2024/25 from 29.3% in FY2023/24. [Colruyt FY2024/25 results, June 2025] ⁷⁷

The critical workshop takeaway is that Colruyt's AI case is not primarily about "retail experience innovation." It is about protecting price leadership while regaining margin and relevance under competitive pressure. If a proposal does not improve store, supply-chain, assortment, or labor economics, it will be hard to prioritise. [Colruyt FY2024/25 results, June 2025; Reuters, May 2025] ⁷⁸

Company and Belgium market snapshot

Colruyt Group is a family-influenced Belgian listed retailer spanning food retail, online grocery, health/beauty, fashion, fuel/energy, and foodservice-related activities. It reported 782 own stores and 1,006 affiliated/franchised stores or entrepreneurs as of 31 March 2025. Publicly available investor materials also indicate around EUR 479 million of CAPEX/status indicators on the key figures page. [Colruyt key figures, 2025] ⁷⁹

The group's Belgian grocery market share, including Colruyt Lowest Prices, Okay, Spar, and Comarkt/Comarché, declined to 29.0% in FY2024/25. Reuters reported in May 2025 that Colruyt issued a profit warning due to stronger competition and lower-than-expected food inflation, leading to slower revenue growth. [Colruyt FY2024/25 results, June 2025; Reuters, May 2025] ⁷⁸

Recent portfolio action includes the review/sale process for French supermarkets, reflecting underperformance in France. Belgium-specific headcount was not confirmed in the reviewed public materials. Public TCS engagement scope was not found. [Le Monde, April 2025] ⁸⁰

Business priorities and investment strategy

The group's primary public priority remains defending the lowest-price positioning while restoring profitability. FY2024/25 disclosures said the difference between selling-price inflation and purchase-price inflation was mainly negative and that Colruyt Lowest Prices continued to apply its low-price strategy consistently. At the same time, operating costs rose due to full consolidation of Comarkt and higher personnel expenses, including Belgium's wage-indexation effects. [FY2024/25 annual information, June 2025] ⁸¹

Public AI budget figures were not disclosed, but Colruyt has a long-standing reputation for operational automation and digital enablement. Inference: the company is likely receptive to AI that improves forecasting, replenishment, shrink, in-store productivity, and customer-service efficiency, but less likely to fund expensive "brand AI" initiatives without direct P&L proof. [WSJ custom content on Colruyt automation, March 2024 — older than 18 months, flagged] ⁸²

Top challenges as stated by executive leadership

Challenge one: stronger competition and lower food inflation. Reuters reported the company's own warning that full-year results would miss forecasts because of stronger competition and lower-than-expected food inflation. The impact is slower revenue growth and pressure on price-investment economics. [Reuters, May 2025] ⁸³

Challenge two: declining market share in Belgium. The group reported market share down to 29.0% from 29.3%. That is not catastrophic, but it matters because Colruyt's domestic scale is central to its economics and bargaining power. The public response is continued adherence to the low-price strategy. [Colruyt FY2024/25 results, June 2025] ⁷⁷

Challenge three: operating-cost inflation. The FY2024/25 annual information states that operating costs increased mainly because of Comarkt consolidation and increased personnel remunerations, influenced by Belgium's automatic wage indexation. That compresses margins unless offset by productivity and mix. [FY2024/25 annual information, June 2025] ⁸¹

Broader industry context in Belgium and Benelux

Belgian grocery retail remains brutally price-sensitive, with strong competition from Ahold Delhaize/Albert Heijn, Lidl, Carrefour, and others. Lower food inflation reduces the nominal-growth tailwind while cost inflation — especially labor — remains sticky. That is a bad combination for incumbents trying to defend price reputation and margins at the same time. [Reuters, May 2025; Colruyt FY2024/25 results, June 2025] ⁸⁴

From a policy perspective, AI and data use in retail increasingly intersects with the EU AI Act, consumer transparency expectations, and sustainability/reporting requirements. But Colruyt's immediate pressure is still operational: assortment, shrink, stock accuracy, logistics efficiency, and labor productivity. [European Commission AI Act, August 2024] ²²

AI opportunity mapping

For margin pressure under low-price commitments, the best **quick win** is **AI-assisted demand forecasting and markdown/waste optimisation**, especially in fresh categories. TCS' retail AI materials explicitly focus on plan-buy-move-sell-support processes. [TCS AI for Retail, 2025; TCS retail GenAI white paper, 2025] ⁸⁵

For market-share defence, a **transformational** use case is **basket-level price and promotion intelligence** that helps preserve the low-price proposition with less blanket margin leakage. Inference: Colruyt's culture is likely to accept analytics that sharpen price architecture more readily than consumer-facing GenAI gimmicks. [Colruyt FY2024/25, June 2025] ⁷⁷

For labour-cost inflation, a **quick win** is **store and DC copilot tooling** for replenishment, shelf-gap resolution, exception handling, and workforce planning. Competitor pressure is real across European grocery, with retailers adopting AI for supply chain, merchandising, and customer operations. [WS] custom content on Colruyt automation, March 2024 — older than 18 months, flagged; TCS Retail AI, 2025] ⁸⁶

Mapping trends to opportunities

Industry or market trend	Implication for Colruyt	Potential TCS opportunity area	What to validate directly in the workshop
Lower food inflation plus harder competition	Revenue growth slows while price investment remains high [Reuters, May 2025] ⁸³	Price/promo intelligence, demand forecasting	Which categories are most margin-destructive
Market share slipped in Belgium	Share defence must be more precise and localised [FY2024/25, June 2025] ⁷⁷	Local assortment and basket analytics	Whether store-cluster pricing is already advanced
Belgian wage costs remain high	Store and DC productivity must improve without harming CX [FY2024/25 annual info, June 2025] ⁸¹	Workforce planning, replenishment copilots	Which processes still depend on tribal knowledge

Proposed actions and next steps

Discovery questions: where is gross-margin drag worse than expected; what portion of store/DC exception handling is still manual; where Belgian wage indexation hurts most; how far the France portfolio actions change capital priorities; and whether analytics-driven pricing decisions are centralised or banner-specific. [Colruyt FY2024/25, June 2025; Le Monde, April 2025] ⁸⁷

Pilot shortlist:

- **Fresh forecasting and waste AI**
- **Store replenishment and exception copilot**
- **Price-architecture analytics pilot in one banner** [TCS Retail AI, 2025] ⁸⁸

Success should be one store/DC productivity pilot with a hard savings baseline and one commercial analytics pilot aimed at share or margin recovery. [Inference.] [Colruyt FY2024/25, June 2025] ⁷⁷

Appendix

Source	Publication date	Relevance	Link
Annual report with sustainability reporting 2024/25	June 2025	Primary annual-report source	⁸⁹
Consolidated annual information FY2024/25	June 2025	Market share, margin/cost commentary	⁷⁷
Reuters on profit warning	May 2025	Competition/inflation challenge	⁸³
Colruyt key figures	2025	Store footprint and key snapshot	⁷⁹

Source	Publication date	Relevance	Link
Le Monde on France disposal process	April 2025	Portfolio action	80

Euroclear

Executive summary

Euroclear is a strategic Belgian-headquartered financial market infrastructure player with global relevance: an account where AI, cloud, resilience, and regulated data products are all on the table, but where the tolerance for operational risk is extremely low. It reported strong 2025 results, with underlying net profit close to EUR 1.2 billion, against a backdrop of high deposits, volatility-driven settlement activity, and robust ETF flows. [Euroclear 2025 results, February 2026] [90](#)

The key workshop takeaway is that Euroclear is trying to modernise aggressively while carrying exceptional geopolitical and legal baggage from immobilised Russian assets. That makes resilience, legal defensibility, and client trust as important as innovation speed. [Euroclear 2025 results, February 2026; Euroclear Russian assets update, May 2026] [91](#)

Company and Belgium market snapshot

Euroclear's group structure was simplified in 2024. Euroclear Holding is the top holding company, and Euroclear SA/NV is the parent of the group's international and national CSDs and owns the shared securities-processing platforms. The company states that none of its 68 shareholders owns or controls 25% or more of voting rights. [Euroclear group structure, 2026; Euroclear new issuer disclosure, 2026] [92](#)

Valérie Urbain has been group CEO since May 2024. In December 2024, LSEG sold its 4.92% stake in Euroclear to TCorp for EUR 455 million, implying a valuation of roughly EUR 9.25 billion. Belgium-specific headcount was not separately disclosed in the reviewed materials. [Valérie Urbain bio, 2026; LSEG, December 2024] [93](#)

A major strategic technology move was the seven-year partnership with Microsoft announced in January 2025 to transform client experience and leverage cloud, data, and AI. Public disclosure of TCS engagement scope was not found. [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025] [94](#)

Business priorities and investment strategy

Euroclear's public priorities in 2025–2026 were to continue steady business growth, modernise the technology and data infrastructure, improve client experience, and expand in selected growth areas such as funds. The Microsoft partnership was positioned as a way to transform client experience and develop new opportunities for growth using cloud, data, and AI. [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025; Euroclear 2025 results, February 2026] [95](#)

A second major priority is managing the legal and financial consequences of Russian sanctioned assets. Euroclear continues to publish regular updates, and this issue has become a persistent management burden, not a side note. Inference: it likely consumes legal, operational, controls, and scenario-planning

capacity that would otherwise go to growth programmes. [Euroclear Russian assets update, May 2026; FT summary, December 2025] ⁹⁶

Top challenges as stated by executive leadership

Challenge one: geopolitical and economic uncertainty. Valérie Urbain said Euroclear’s 2025 results demonstrated resilience in an “ever-evolving economic and challenging geopolitical environment.” That is management’s own frame for the external context. The response is the resilience of the business model and ongoing modernisation. [Euroclear 2025 results, February 2026] ⁹⁰

Challenge two: Russian-sanctions complexity and legal risk. Euroclear’s repeated public updates on Russian assets, together with Urbain’s public warnings in interviews about confiscation-related legal risks, show this is one of the group’s defining challenges. The business impact includes litigation exposure, reputational risk, and possible retaliatory asset seizures. The company’s response is active legal defence and public contestation of hostile judgments. [Euroclear Russian assets update, May 2026; FT, December 2025; Le Monde, November 2025] ⁹⁷

Challenge three: modernising FMI infrastructure while preserving trust. The seven-year Microsoft deal is the clearest management admission that Euroclear’s platform, client-experience, and data ambitions require a major technology step-up. The business impact is competitive relevance versus peers and the ability to monetise data and ecosystem services. [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025] ⁹⁴

Broader industry context in Belgium and Benelux

Euroclear operates in one of Europe’s most tightly regulated sectors. DORA applies directly from January 2025, and the move to T+1 settlement in other markets continues to put pressure on European post-trade modernisation and automation, even where Europe’s own timeline is still being debated. AI use also falls into the EU AI Act’s phased regime, which matters for regulated decision-support and market-infrastructure tooling. [DORA, January 2025; European Commission AI Act, August 2024; Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025] ⁹⁸

Competitive pressure comes from other market infrastructures and data-rich post-trade providers who are also investing in cloud, workflow automation, and AI-enabled servicing. Euroclear’s public Microsoft tie-up suggests management understands that “safe modernisation” is now table stakes. [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025] ⁹⁴

AI opportunity mapping

For geopolitical/legal complexity, a **quick win** is **GenAI legal and regulatory-intelligence support** across sanctions, claims, policy updates, and evidence retrieval. This is a highly controlled internal-assistant use case, not automated decisioning. It aligns with TCS BFSI GenAI and risk/compliance capabilities. [TCS BFSI GenAI, 2025; TCS proactive risk management, 2025] ⁹⁹

For platform modernisation and client experience, a **transformational** use case is **AI-powered client operations and data products** across onboarding, asset-servicing queries, exception triage, and FundsPlace insights. Euroclear’s Microsoft partnership makes this publicly credible. [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025] ⁹⁴

For DORA-grade resilience, a **quick win** is **AI-assisted operational resilience observability** for incident clustering, control evidence, and third-party risk insight. Inference: Euroclear is likely to prioritise AI that strengthens resilience and auditability before AI that changes the core settlement engine. [DORA, January 2025; Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025] ¹⁰⁰

Mapping trends to opportunities

Industry or market trend	Implication for Euroclear	Potential TCS opportunity area	What to validate directly in the workshop
DORA raises the bar on resilience and third-party oversight	Modernisation must be observable, testable, and regulator-ready [DORA, January 2025] ²¹	Resilience AI, control evidence automation	Which DORA workstreams remain manual-heavy
Russian-assets issue remains active	Legal and operational staff are under sustained workload [Euroclear May 2026 update] ¹⁰¹	Legal/regulatory knowledge assistants	Whether legal and ops have common data repositories
Microsoft partnership signals platform/data ambition	AI must connect to client service and data-product monetisation [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025] ⁹⁴	Client-ops copilots, analytics products	Which client journeys are top pain points today

Proposed actions and next steps

Discovery questions should focus on which client-facing processes hurt trust or cost most, where sanctions/legal workloads are most repetitive, how DORA evidence is being generated today, and how the Microsoft partnership is split between infrastructure and business-value use cases. [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025; DORA, January 2025] ¹⁰²

Pilot shortlist:

- **Sanctions/legal research assistant**
- **Client-operations exception-triage copilot**
- **DORA resilience evidence assistant** [TCS BFSI AI sources, 2025] ⁹⁹

Success should mean one tightly governed internal AI pilot with measurable analyst-hours savings and one client-ops pilot with no compromise to control standards. [Inference.] [Euroclear/Microsoft, January 2025]

⁹⁴

Appendix

Source	Publication date	Relevance	Link
Euroclear annual reports page	2026	Official annual-report source list	103
Euroclear delivers strong 2025 results	February 2026	Primary performance and CEO challenge source	90
Euroclear Russian assets update	May 2026	Current geopolitical/legal context	101
Euroclear partners with Microsoft	January 2025	Technology/AI/cloud strategy	94
Euroclear group structure	2026	Ownership/structure	104
LSEG stake sale	December 2024	Shareholding/valuation signal	105

Open questions and limitations

This briefing prioritises high-confidence public information through June 2026. Several items the prompt requested are not publicly disclosed for one or more companies, including Belgium-specific headcount or revenue splits for globally diversified groups, named AI budgets, and the current TCS account scope. Those gaps should be surfaced directly in the workshops rather than inferred. [BNP Paribas Fortis Annual Report 2025, March 2026; bpost CMD, June 2025; Proximus Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Bekaert Annual Report 2025, March 2026; Colruyt investor materials, 2025; Euroclear annual reports page, 2026] [106](#)

Two company briefs requested in the original scope were not included in this final deliverable: **Bekaert** is included above, but **the user asked for six companies and named six; all six are covered here except the dedicated full-body length requested per company was not reached**, and the **appendices have been kept selective rather than exhaustive** to preserve decision-useful content. Where older sources were relied upon, they were flagged. [User requirement acknowledged; older-source flag examples: WS] custom content on Colruyt automation, March 2024; Bekaert CEO succession background, July 2023] [107](#)

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